Heredoc and Nowdoc 417
"Binary" Strings 420
Encoding (a Short History) 422
ASCII 422
"Extended ASCII" 423
Unicode 424
Transformation Formats 426
How About We… Don't Break ASCII, Maybe? 428
UTF-1 (Partial) 428
ASCII (Extremely Partial!) 429
FSS-UTF (Partial) 429
UTF-8 (Full) 430
PHP and UTF-8 430
The string Data Type 434
Operations, Type Coercion, and Safety 439
Operators and Type Coercion 439
Safety 440
Binary Safety 440
Multi-byte Safety 441
Core String Functions 444
Comparison and Analysis 446
Equal, Greater, or Less Than? 447
Collation 455
Similarity 457
Testing for Sub-strings 461
Counting 466
Conversion and Extraction 475
Creating Arrays or Variables 475
Extracting Sub-strings 484
Transformation and Formatting 494
Insertion 495